

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 5 4

♥ 10 6

♦ J 7 2

♣ 8 6 5 3

♠ A J 10

♥ A K 9 8 5

♦ K 9 6

♣ Q 7



♠ K Q 2

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ 10 8 5 3

♣ 9 2

♠ 8 6 3

♥ 7 3

♦ A Q 4

♣ A K J 10 4

North opens 1♥ - how should you respond? North rebids 2NT. How do you continue? South shows her minimum by bidding 3NT. North continues with 4NT - what does this mean? How do you continue?

North's 4NT was not Blackwood, but rather a quantitative raise in Notrump, and an invitation to slam. You have 15 points, and they are good ones. So you accept the invitation and bid 6NT. There are 11 top tricks. A 3-3♥ split would provide the 12th winner, but this is against the odds. Better to try two ♠ finesses, a 75% chance.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
Lead: ♠K			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 4
 ♥ J 10 5 4
 ♦ 8 5 3
 ♣ Q 10 5 3

♠ Q 6 3

♥ Q 3

♦ A K J 9 4

♣ 9 6 4



♠ K 10

♥ 9 8 7 6 2

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A K 2

♠ A J 8 7 5 2

♥ A K

♦ Q 6

♣ J 8 7

South opens 1♠ - You responds 2♦, natural and game forcing. South rebids 2♠. In our style of 2/1, this promises 6+ cards in spades, and denies a side 4-card suit. What should we bid now?

You should jump to 4♠. This is Fast Arrival, indicating a minimum hand with no particular interest in slam. South is happy to rest in the game contract. Even with a combined 30 points, 10 tricks are certainly not a sure thing. South must hope that East holds the trump King.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♠
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
Lead: ♥J			

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 3

♥ J

♦ 10 9 7 3

♣ K J 6 5 2

♠ A J 10 6 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ Q J

♣ 10 8 7



♠ Q 9 8

♥ 10 7

♦ K 8 6 5 2

♣ Q 9 3

♠ K 5

♥ K Q 9 8 5 4 3

♦ A 4

♣ A 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥ ¹	Pass	5NT ²
Pass	6♥ ³		
All Pass			

1. 2 keycards, no trump Q
2. king ask
3. no kings lower than hearts

Lead: ♠3

North opens 1♠. What do you respond with? You have a powerhouse, plenty strong enough to jump-shift. But playing 2/1 it's usually simpler when you make the 2/1 response, and save your jumping for later - if at all. So just bid 2♥, knowing North must keep the bidding open. North responds 3♥, setting the trump suit. Now you are definitely interested in slam. Since you have controls in all the side suits, you go right to keycard Blackwood, using the 1430 system. Partner responds 5♥.

Partner's 5♥ shows two keycards without the trump queen. But we have the other 3 keycards, and the trump queen. If partner has the two minor kings we might have a grand. We ask about these with our 5NT bid. Unfortunately, partner responds 6♥ (playing specific kings, this denies any kings lower than hearts). We will pass and play there. This is a good slam, cold if West makes any opening lead other than a ♣. With a ♣ lead, South will have to pull trumps and play to discard a loser on the ♠10.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 9 6 5 3
♥ 9 8 4
♦ A 9 3
♣ 5 3

♠ A

♥ A Q J 7 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ K J 4



♠ 10 8 7 4

♥ 6 2

♦ J 10

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ K 10

♦ K Q 8 6 5

♣ Q 8 7

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

Lead: ♠ 7

How do you start this action? [Bid 1H] You open 1 ♥ and partner responds 2 ♦. What do you rebid? Partner's 2 over 1 bid sets up a game force. You have a good-looking hand, but you need to find a trump suit before showing extra strength, so she bids just 2 ♥. You are in a game forcing auction, so partner won't pass you. Partner now jumps to 4 ♥. What do you do now?

Partner's jump to 4 ♥ is Fast Arrival - showing a minimum game forcing hand. Even though we have extra values, this won't be enough for slam opposite 13 or so points.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ A J 10 8
 ♣ A 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ 10 4

♦ K 6 5

♣ K 8 7



♠ K 9 7 5 4 3

♥ A 6

♦ Q 9 7

♣ J 6

♠ J

♥ K Q J 7 5 3

♦ 4 3 2

♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
Lead: ♠ 10			

North opens 1 ♠. You have 11 points, enough to respond 2 ♥ in standard bidding, but not when using 2/1. So we use the forcing 1NT. North rebids 2 ♣. This only promises 3 clubs, so is really just there so we can better describe our hand with our second bid. What do we bid now?

Now we can bid 2H, and it shows 6+ ♥s and only 6-10 points. North was forced to reply to 1NT, but he is not forced to bid again. With his minimum hand and a tolerance for partner's suit he just passes and the partnership ends up in a reasonable contract. This hand demonstrates one of the benefits of Forcing 1NT. In standard bidding South's first response would be 2 ♥, and North would have to bid again, probably 2NT. The partnership might go even higher but in any case would probably not reach a good contract.